

Directed writing

Paper 2 · Section A · 40 marks | syllabus 2027-2029

What you will learn

Evaluate two viewpoints and write a persuasive, audience-aware response based on the texts.

How this assessment works

All candidates take Paper 1. Centres then enter candidates for Paper 2 or the Coursework Portfolio. Speaking and Listening is optional and separately endorsed. The supplied June 2026 papers inform presentation only; question structure and word limits in this guide follow the 2027-2029 syllabus.

Evaluate source reasoning

Part 1(a) asks you to analyse or evaluate how a writer presents an idea, worth 5 marks. Identify a claim, the evidence offered, its persuasive effect and a possible limit. Do not merely repeat the passage. A survey of existing users, for example, may miss people who never visit.

Worked example

The figure “112 of 180” lends the proposal apparent support, but the sample includes only library users; it does not show what non-users need.

Synthesize before taking a position

In 1(b), use and assess source ideas as evidence for your own argument. Acknowledge a credible objection, answer it with a practical condition, and propose measurable action. This part carries 10 reading and 25 writing marks; write about 250-350 words. Speech, letter, article or report must suit audience and purpose.

Worked example

A balanced recommendation could trial two evenings while publishing staffing costs and usage data, then compare those results with a mobile collection point.

Practice paper

Directed writing

All passages and questions in this FagusED practice are original. Write in English. Marks appear in square brackets. Use the lines provided; extra paper may be attached if required.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Quick check · FagusED diagnostic (outside the Cambridge paper)

A brief study check; the official 0500 written papers use structured and extended answers.

What strengthens evaluation?

- A Only copying a statistic
- B Explaining who a survey excludes
- C Ignoring the second text
- D Repeating the title

Reading texts

Text A: The case for longer library opening hours

When the community library closes at five, many people are still travelling home. A student with a crowded household may need its quiet tables after dinner; an adult who works shifts may have only an evening to borrow a book. A local survey of 180 users found that 112 would visit at least twice a month after six. That does not prove every later opening would be busy, but it suggests demand worth testing.

The library can offer more than books. Its computers provide access to applications and services that increasingly assume everyone has a reliable internet connection. Staff can help visitors find trustworthy information, and community groups can meet in a familiar public space. A trial on two evenings a week, supported by volunteers for routine tasks, could show whether these benefits outweigh the costs.

I understand the concern about energy bills and staff hours. Those figures should be published before decisions are made, and the trial should end if attendance is too low. Yet closing early without testing alternatives leaves a significant group of residents without a realistic way to use a service they already support.

Text B: A cautious view of evening opening

Later hours sound generous, but an open door also needs trained staff, heating, security and cleaning. Volunteers cannot replace librarians who have expertise in safeguarding and helping visitors. Our library's budget already stretches to cover daytime services; if an evening trial absorbs that budget, the purchase of new books or children's events might suffer. A survey of current users may overlook residents who rarely visit because they lack transport or prefer digital services.

Before extending the timetable, the council could test smaller changes: a weekly mobile collection point,

easier online reservations and book deliveries for people who cannot travel. Local schools and workplaces might also collect reserved items. These options require planning, but some could reach people who would never be able to visit late at night.

If a trial goes ahead, it should have measurable goals, a clear end date and published costs. Staff should be consulted about safety and rotas. It is reasonable to ask who gains from longer hours and who may lose a service as a result. The library belongs to the whole community, including people who cannot stand in a queue at seven in the evening.

A recent weekend event provides a warning about simple attendance figures. More than fifty visitors came through the doors, but twenty were already regular users collecting reserved books, and several arrived only because a school group happened to be nearby. The event was useful, yet it did not establish a lasting pattern. We should ask what people need at particular times, whether they can reach the building safely and whether existing resources can meet those needs. A consultation should include young people, carers and non-users as well as those who already know how to make their voices heard.

The present staff team might welcome a carefully scheduled experiment, provided shifts are agreed in advance. Staff have asked for an additional security check and for clear rules about closing the building. Any public promise should acknowledge the people who will have to deliver it, because a popular timetable that cannot be staffed reliably helps no one.

Questions

1(a) How does the writer of Text A try to make the case for evening opening convincing? Comment on evidence and one limitation. **[5]**

Answers and teacher guidance

Check your response only after finishing the practice. Responses can be expressed in other valid words when their meanings are supported by the source.

1(a) The exact survey figure gives an impression of measurable demand [1]; the writer acknowledges that it cannot prove every evening will be busy [1], suggesting a balanced position; specific users such as shift workers and students make the effect concrete [1]; a two-evening trial with costs published is a testable proposal [1]; however, surveying existing users may omit people currently excluded [1].

1(b) Model response (about 284 words). A library that people can actually use. The council should widen access to our library, but the most responsible choice is a limited evening trial alongside alternatives for residents who cannot visit the building at all.

The case for later opening is real. Students in crowded homes need a quiet place to work, while shift workers may finish after the doors close. Library computers also matter to people completing forms without a reliable connection at home. A survey found that 112 of 180 current users would visit after six at least twice a month. That is a reason to test a change, not proof that every evening will be busy.

Text B raises equally practical questions. Heating, security and trained staff cost money; volunteers cannot simply replace librarians. If late opening takes funds from children's events or new books, access may worsen for other groups. The weekend event mentioned in Text B also shows why a single attendance figure cannot reveal lasting demand.

I propose two evenings a week for one term, with staff involved in planning rotas and safety checks. The council should publish costs, usage and a target for deciding whether to continue. At the same time, it should trial easier reservations and a mobile collection point, then ask non-users, carers and young people whether these services help.

A fair decision will compare what each option achieves for the money spent and who remains excluded. The aim is neither a permanently extended timetable nor an early closing rule defended out of habit: it is a library whose services reach the people who need them. Reading [10]: developed and evaluated ideas from both texts. Writing [25]: clear article voice, reasoned argument, structure and accuracy.

Diagnostic answer

1: B

Source for assessment structure: Cambridge IGCSE First Language English 0500 syllabus for 2027–2029, <https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/718783-2027-2029-syllabus.pdf>. Original passages and questions by FagusED; June 2026 papers and mark schemes supplied by the user consulted for response layout and feedback style. This is independent study material, not an official Cambridge paper.